

ACTIVITY 1 — LEARNER WORKSHEET**Yellow Belt Role, Certification Paths, and Improvement Scenario**

TYPE	DURATION	DMAIC PHASE
Core Activity	30 min	FOUNDATIONS

Name	
Date	

What you are doing

Establish what a Lean Six Sigma Yellow Belt is accountable for, how the belt pathway progresses from White to Master Black Belt, and choose a small, manageable improvement scenario to carry through the whole course.

What you will produce: A Yellow Belt responsibility table, a belt-pathway comparison and a selected improvement scenario justified against all four criteria.

Tools and techniques: Belt role matrix, CSSC certification pathway, project selection criteria

The scenario

Contoso Service Desk handles employee IT requests. Employees complain that tickets take too long to be assigned, that they must keep chasing for status, and that agents apply different definitions of what counts as "resolved". Handoffs between the front line and the specialist queues are unclear, and although ticket data exists it is inconsistent. You are supporting the improvement team as a Yellow Belt — you do not lead the project.

Two weeks of data have been collected: 400 tickets, of which 96 contained at least one defect, with 120 defects recorded in total across 6 defect opportunities per ticket. Mean assignment time is 55 minutes (median 46) against a 30-minute improvement goal. The CSV files in this activity's data/ folder are that extract.

Files in this activity folder**data/ — the mock data you analyse:**

- service-desk-tickets.csv — 400 rows (ticket_id, date, ticket_type, channel, assigned_queue, agent, assignment_time_min, met_30min_goal, defect_count, defect_categories, reopened)

templates/ — the worksheets you complete:

- belt-pathway-comparison.csv (belt, typical_role, training_days, leads_or_supports, typical_project_scope)
- project-selection-criteria.csv (criterion, does_the_scenario_meet_it, evidence)

- yellow-belt-responsibilities.csv (responsibility, your_contribution, belt_that_leads_it)

Open these in Excel, Google Sheets or LibreOffice Calc. Work on a copy so the originals stay clean for revision.

The scenario brief and the two weeks of ticket data are in data/.

Your steps

1. Define the Yellow Belt role — list at least four responsibilities and your contribution to each.
2. Compare the White, Yellow, Green, Black and Master Black Belt pathways in a table.
3. Review the Contoso Service Desk scenario: tickets are slow to be assigned and status is unclear.
4. Test your scenario against the 'good project' criteria — day-to-day work, manageable, aligned to business goals, data available.
5. Record why a Yellow Belt supports rather than leads this improvement.

Your working space

Complete every field. Keep this worksheet — it is your reference for applying the method at work.

Step 1 — Define the Yellow Belt role — list at least four responsibilities and your contributi...

Step 2 — Compare the White, Yellow, Green, Black and Master Black Belt pathways in a table.

Step 3 — Review the Contoso Service Desk scenario: tickets are slow to be assigned and status...

Step 4 — Test your scenario against the 'good project' criteria — day-to-day work, manageable,...

Step 5 — Record why a Yellow Belt supports rather than leads this improvement.

Answers to the discussion prompts

1. Where does a Yellow Belt add the most value on a DMAIC project, and where should they hand over?

2. Which of the four 'good project' criteria is most often ignored in your own workplace?

3. What would make the Contoso scenario a BAD Six Sigma project?

Reflect & discuss

Name one process at your workplace that would pass all four selection criteria.

What would you need permission for before collecting data on it?

Check your work

You can state the Yellow Belt role in one sentence and justify your scenario against all four selection criteria.